

Windows 7. And you need to check your wallet too! While there may not be a very compelling reason to jump over, there's no reason to step back either. We recommend installing a trial on your PC and try it out for about a week (Microsoft says new users take about a week to adjust to the new UI). If you like it, you should buy a license. If not, Windows 7 isn't retiring and you should stick with that.

Where to buy and for how much

Given the fact that ours is a country where software piracy is rampant and it's tough to locate a store which actually sells genuine Windows, purchasing the DVD online is your best bet. However, the discs may not be in oblivion if you live in a city.



Windows 8 upgrade offer

At the time of writing, the retail price of Windows 8 is unclear and the Microsoft website won't allow us to purchase Windows 8. There was an offer that would allow you to upgrade an existing version of Windows to Windows 8, but that offer has probably ended by now. Official pricing of Windows 8 is set at \$199 though a specific price for

India hasn't been announced yet. Keep an eye on <http://windows.microsoft.com/en-IN/windows/buy> for updates.

Existing Windows 7 customers can upgrade to Windows 8 by paying just ₹699. There is a small catch though. You need to have purchased your Windows 7 copy between 2nd June 2012 and 31st January 2013 to be eligible for this offer. The last day to register and order your Windows 8 upgrade is 28 February 2013. For more info visit : <http://www.windowsupgradeoffer.com/en-IN>

Installation methods

There are two ways to get Windows 8 running on your machine – you either upgrade your existing Windows installation or you create a new one. The simplest installation method is also the most common one – installation of the OS from scratch. You pop in a DVD, boot from it and the installer comes up. You partition the hard disk, a few extra clicks and the OS comes to life. If you've ever performed a Windows setup, you would already be aware of how this works. There are no new surprises here.